

GADGETS ON A BUDGET

10 GADGET IDEAS TO SOLVE EVERYDAY NIGGLES FOR CASH-STRAPPED STUDENTS

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If there's one thing students will agree on universally, it's how cash strapped they all are. Students are perennially looking for the cheapest alternative to get the job done. Sure, quality matters, but sometimes price matters even more, and for those times there's nothing quite like finding the perfect *jugaad*. In this part of the cover story we'll give you our list of 10 best gadgets that will help you win this year.



1 LAPTOP LOCK CABLE

You got yourself a shiny new laptop and you couldn't be happier. You are by yourself in the library busily hammering away that submission which is due the next day. Suddenly nature calls, as it always does, when you least expect it. You say to yourself you won't be long and pop out to do your business. When you return *gasp* your laptop's gone! Now you could've asked someone to keep an eye on it while you are away and while it might've worked when you are in the library, but certainly not in your canteen or common room. For these very situations it's best to get one of these Kensington lock cables. The one we have suggested here is slightly longer than most of the listings out there. While the specs list it at 1 meter some of the user reviews say it's longer – because, you know, length matters!

Buy: <http://dgit.in/Laplok> (₹250)



2 CHEAP HDMI STREAMER

Access to screens isn't very difficult these days. In fact, many hostel roommates might even chip in for a 32-inch TV. Though you could always connect your laptop directly to the TV, but it tends to get cumbersome in the long run. A simpler solution is to get one of these Smart TV dongles or HDMI streamers. The one featured here – EZCast – can even access folder structures on an HDD that's connected to your network and play files off it! You can use your laptop to trigger any file you can access. You can even stream YouTube videos from your phone. Quite a nifty thing to have around for those short (or long) study breaks. Plus, it's certainly cheaper than a Chromecast!

Buy: <http://dgit.in/CHEzCast> (₹1,395)